Reading Habits of Graduate Students

This short report describes how graduate students in a language department use the university library. We asked forty students to keep a reading diary for two weeks and to note every book, article and dictionary they consulted. Most students read journal articles online, but printed books remain important for literature and translation courses.

Students who translate literary texts borrow more dictionaries and reference grammars than other students. Several participants said that they compare two or three translations of the same novel before they write their own version. The library plans to buy more parallel editions and to keep the reading room open later during the examination period.